

XPman User Manual

Version 1.0.1-SNAPSHOT (2026-10-09)

The XPman Team

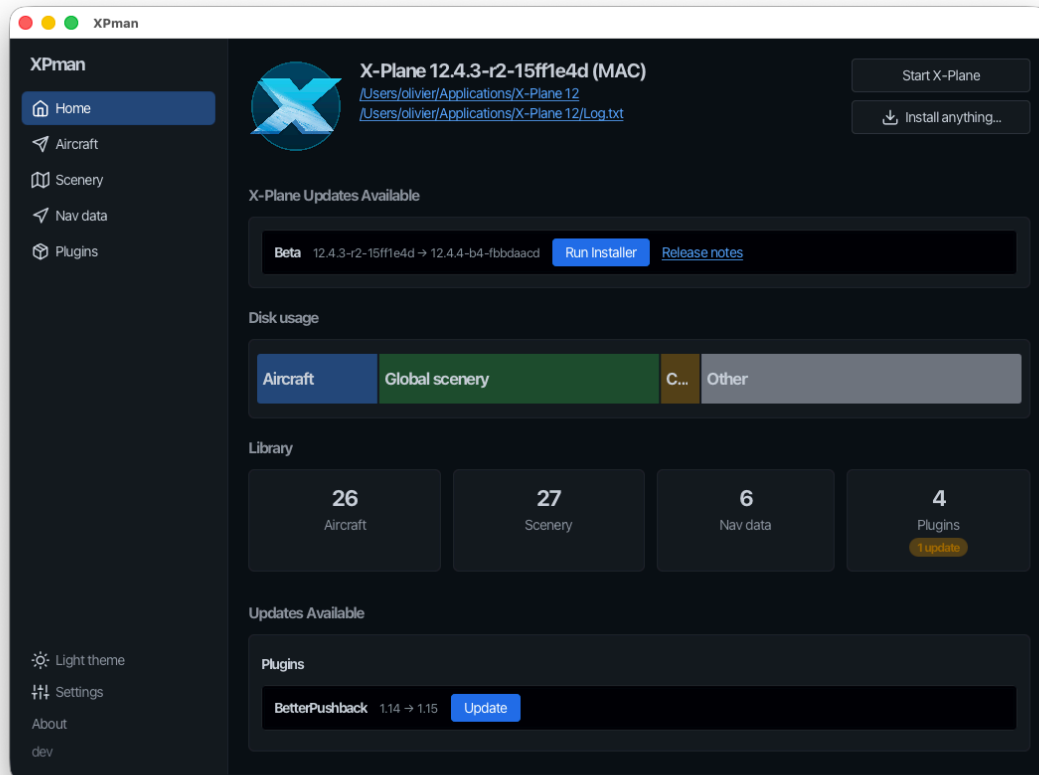
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Introduction

XPman is a cross-platform configuration manager for X-Plane 11 and 12. It lets you browse, install, update, and organize your aircraft, scenery, plugins, and tools from a single desktop application.



The XPman main window.

Features

- **Aircraft** — Install, delete, and manage aircraft and liveries. Recognize specific aircraft models for version checking and update notifications.
- **Scenery** — Install scenery packages and auto-order scenery_packs.ini for optimal load order.
- **Plugins** — Install, delete, and manage global plugins. System plugins are protected from deletion. Plugin versions extracted from native binaries. PDF manuals supported.
- **FlyWithLua** — Manage FlyWithLua scripts with SGES integration.
- **Nav data** — List and manage navigation data sets, including XP12 airspace and ATC data.

- **Tools** — Install and uninstall generic tools from manifest files, with custom install directory support.
- **X-Plane updates** — Get notified when a new X-Plane version is available and start the updater.
- **Disk usage** — View disk space consumed by each category (aircraft, scenery, plugins, etc.).
- **Skunkcrafts Updater integration** — Detect and apply updates for addons that support the Skunkcrafts Updater protocol.

Installation

Download the latest release for your platform from GitHub Releases. All packages are bundled with a Java runtime — no separate Java installation required.

Platform	Format
macOS	.dmg or .pkg
Windows	.exe or .msi
Linux	.deb or .rpm

Windows

When running the EXE or MSI, Windows SmartScreen may display a warning. Click **More info** then **Run anyway** — XPman is 100% open source and all build code is public and auditable.

macOS

macOS may block the app because it is not signed with an Apple Developer ID. Go to **System Settings > Privacy & Security** and click **Open Anyway** to allow it to run.

Getting Started

Selecting Your X-Plane Folder

On first launch, XPman prompts you to select your X-Plane installation directory. Use **File** → **Select X-Plane folder...** at any time to switch installations. If you select a folder that is not a valid X-Plane installation, XPman shows the error “**Invalid X-Plane folder**” — make sure you select the top-level directory containing the X-Plane executable.

XPman remembers your last folder and reopens it automatically on startup.

Recent Folders

File → **Open Recent** lists recently opened X-Plane installations. If a folder no longer exists (e.g. you moved or deleted it), XPman offers to remove it from the list.

Main Window Layout

The main window is divided into two areas:

- **Sidebar** (left) — Navigation panels: Home, Aircraft, Scenery, Nav data, Plugins. The sidebar footer has a Light/Dark theme toggle, Settings, and About buttons, plus a version label.
- **Content area** (right) — Shows the selected panel.

Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Cmd/Ctrl + 1..5	Jump to panel (Home, Aircraft, Scenery, Nav data, Plugins)
Cmd/Ctrl + ,	Open Settings
Cmd/Ctrl + Q	Quit

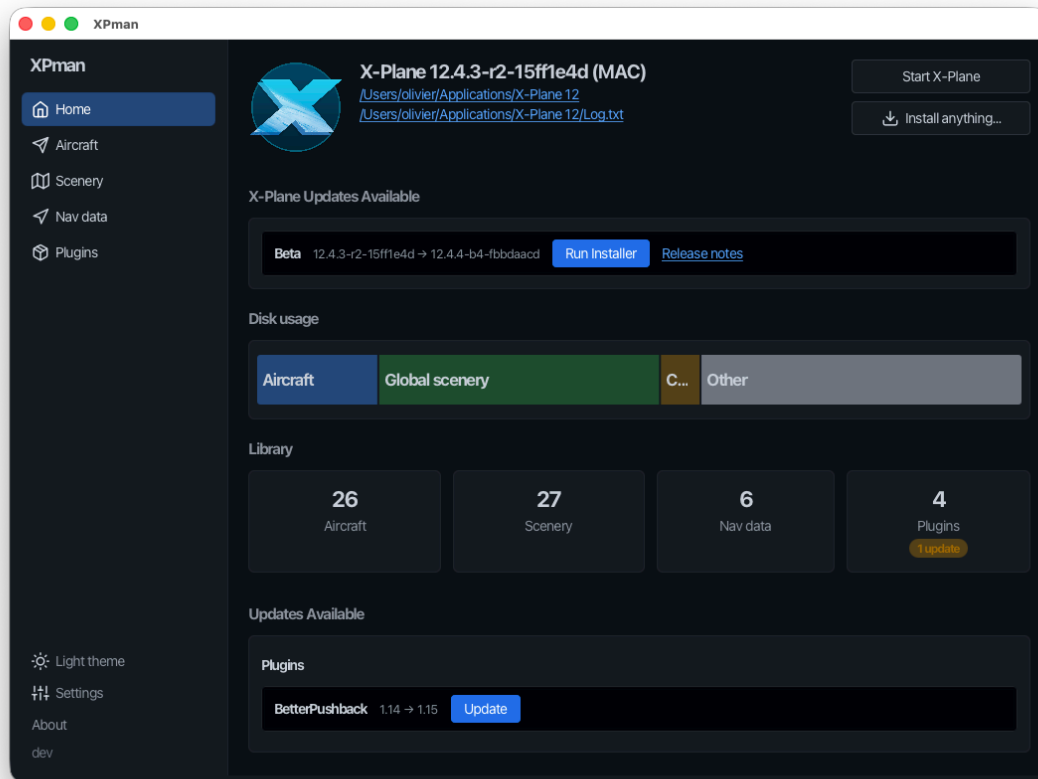
Theme

Click **Light theme** or **Dark theme** in the sidebar footer to toggle. XPman uses the AtlantaFX Primer theme for both modes.

Window Position

XPman remembers your window position and size between launches, so you don't have to rearrange it every time.

Home Dashboard



The Home dashboard.

X-Plane Header

The header shows X-Plane {version} ({variant}) for your selected installation, or **“No X-Plane installation selected”** if none is open. The folder path is a hyperlink — click it to reveal the X-Plane executable in Finder / Explorer / Files. The **Log file** hyperlink opens the X-Plane log.

Start X-Plane

The **Start X-Plane** button launches X-Plane. It is disabled if the selected X-Plane installation is for a different platform (e.g. you opened a Windows install on macOS).

The **Install anything...** button opens the universal install wizard (see Installing Add-ons).

X-Plane Updates Available

When a new X-Plane version is available, the dashboard shows rows for **Release** and/or **Beta** updates with a version arrow (current → available). Click **Run Installer** to launch the

updater. A **Release notes** link is shown when available. Beta updates show a confirmation dialog with the hint: *“Check for new betas as well as updates.”*

Disk Usage

A horizontal segmented bar shows disk space consumed by: Aircraft, Global scenery, Custom scenery, Disabled scenery, and Other. Hover over a segment for details. Sizes are computed asynchronously.

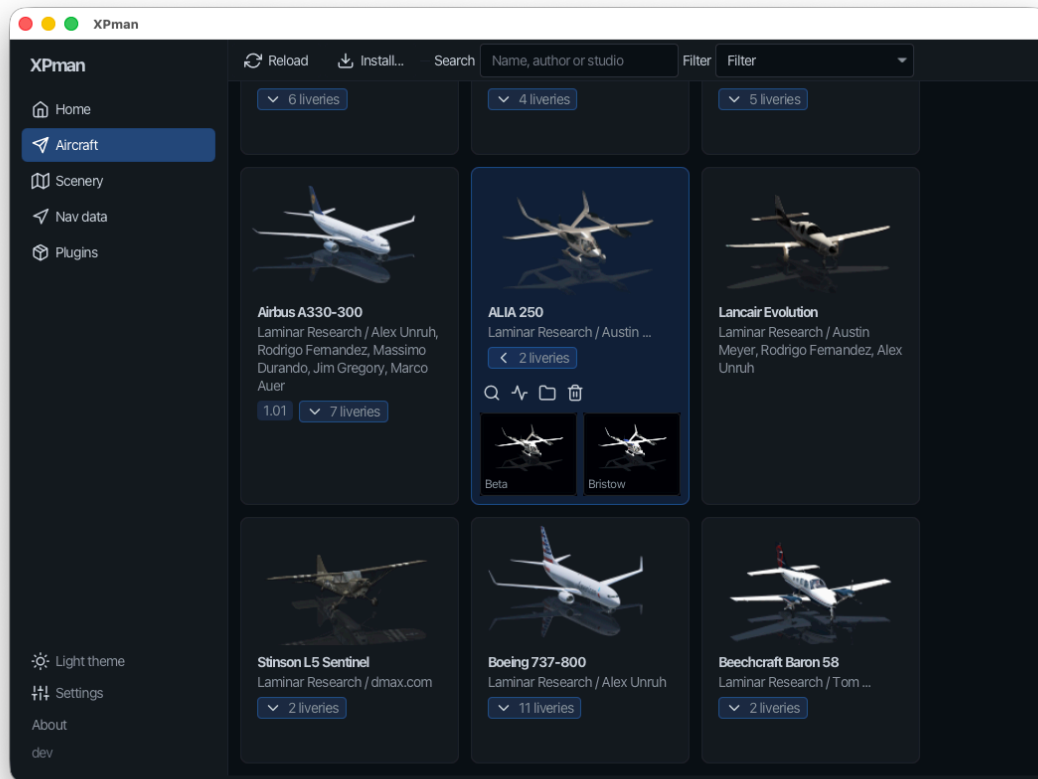
Library Tiles

Four clickable tiles let you jump to each management panel: **Aircraft**, **Scenery**, **Nav data**, **Plugins**. Each tile shows a badge with N updates when Skunkcrafts updates are available for that category. Disabled plugins and scenery are excluded from the update count.

Updates Available

When enabled addons support the Skunkcrafts Updater protocol and have updates pending, they are listed here grouped by **Aircraft**, **Scenery**, and **Plugins**. Disabled plugins and scenery are omitted. Each row shows the addon name, current → latest, and an **Update** button that opens the Skunkcrafts update wizard (see Updating Add-ons).

Aircraft



The Aircraft panel.

Toolbar

- **Reload** — Re-scan the X-Plane aircraft folder.
- **Install...** — Open the universal install wizard to install an aircraft from a .zip or .7z archive (see Installing Add-ons).
- **Search** — Filter aircraft by name, author, or studio (debounced for responsiveness).
- **Filter** — Dropdown: All, Category: ..., Studio: ..., Studio $\neq$ Laminar Research.

Card Grid

Each aircraft is displayed as a card with:

- **Thumbnail** image
- **Name** and **studio / author**
- **Badges**: version, Update available (when a Skunkcrafts update exists), N liveries (expandable to show livery mini-cards)

Hover over a card to reveal icon buttons: **Explore properties**, **Inspect**, **Reveal**, **Uninstall**.

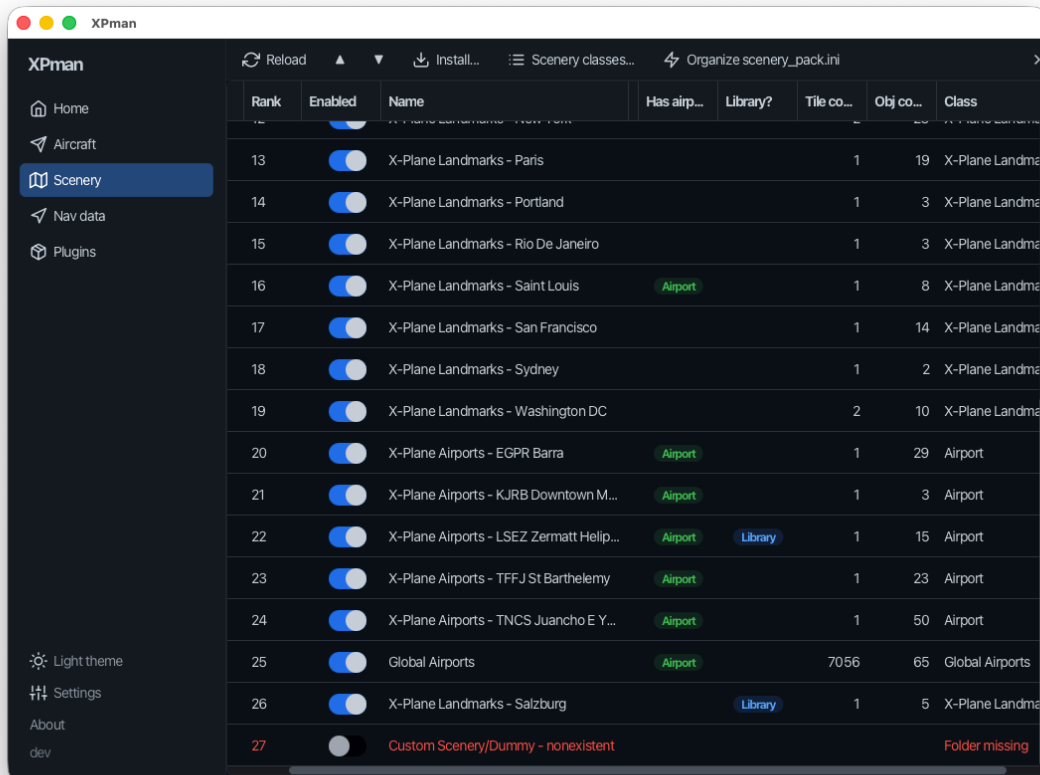
Double-click a card to open the **Aircraft details** window — a Name/Value tree of the ACF file's properties.

Context Menu

Right-click a card or livery for additional actions:

- **Reveal in Finder / Show in Explorer / Show in Files** (platform-dependent label)
- **Uninstall aircraft** — Shows a confirmation dialog listing the aircraft that will be removed.
- **Inspect** — Opens the Inspection results window showing the outcome of all inspections.
- **Explore properties** — Opens the Aircraft details window (same as double-click).
- **Update via Skunkcrafts Updater** — Opens the Skunkcrafts update wizard (when applicable).
- **Skunkcrafts: Locked by developer** — Shown when the developer has disabled remote updates.
- **Links** — Dynamic submenu with links from the addon's manifest.
- **Manuals** — Dynamic submenu listing PDF manuals bundled with the aircraft.

Scenery



The Scenery panel.

The scenery panel allows you to view sceneries and manage the entries of your scenery_packs.ini file. Control order, enable or disable them, or let the wizard re-order them.

Note: changes are never saved automatically; whenever a change is made, the message “UNSAVED CHANGES” appears, and you will need to press the “Save” button to save the changes to scenery_packs.ini.

Toolbar

- **Reload** — Re-scan scenery packages.
- **▲ / ▼** — Move the selected scenery pack up or down one rank in scenery_packs.ini.
- **Install...** — Open the universal install wizard for scenery packages.
- **Scenery classes...** — Open the Scenery classes window (see Scenery Classes).
- **Organize scenery_pack.ini** — Automatically reorder scenery_packs.ini by class rank (see below).
- **Open scenery_packs.ini** — Open the file in your system text editor.

Table

The table lists all discovered scenery packages. Columns:

Column	Description
Icon	Package type indicator
Update marker	Shown when an enabled scenery package has a Skunkcrafts update available
Rank	Position in scenery_packs.ini
Enabled	Toggle switch (only for entries listed in scenery_packs.ini)
Name	Package name
Version	Package version
Has airport?	Pill shown if the package contains an airport
Library?	Pill shown if the package is a library
Tile count	Number of terrain tiles
Obj count	Number of OBJ objects
Class	Organizer class (e.g. Airport, Library, X-Plane Landmark); shows Folder missing when the directory no longer exists

Hover over a column header for a tooltip explaining its purpose.

Reordering

Drag rows to reorder (ini-listed entries only), or use the ▲ / ▼ toolbar buttons. A drop-target highlight shows the insertion point.

Enable / Disable

Toggle the **Enabled** switch to include or exclude a package from `scenery_packs.ini`. Disabled entries are styled differently. Entries whose folder is missing are also visually distinct.

Context Menu

Right-click a row for:

- **Reveal**
- **Enable Scenery Package / Disable Scenery Package**
- **Add to scenery_packs.ini / Remove from scenery_packs.ini**
- **Uninstall** — Confirmation dialog with details.
- **Inspect** — Opens Inspection results.
- **Update via Skunkcrafts Updater** — Available only for enabled packages that support updates.
- **Skunkcrafts: Locked by developer**
- **Links** — Dynamic submenu.

Organize Workflow

1. Click **Organize scenery_pack.ini**.
2. A confirmation dialog appears: *“This will add unlisted scenery packages, remove invalid entries, and sort scenery packages by class rank. No change will be saved until you click on the ‘Save’ button.”*
3. After organizing, the **UNSAVED CHANGES** indicator appears in the toolbar.
4. Review the new order in the table.
5. Click **Save** to persist the changes to `scenery_packs.ini`.

Empty State

When no scenery packages are found, the panel shows **“No scenery to show”**.

Scenery Classes

Scenery classes have two functions: - categorize the scenery packs - provide the ranking for automatic ordering when “Organize scenery_packs.ini” is activated.

Each scenery pack is assigned a class in two steps: 1) the name-matching (regex) rules are tried first, from top to bottom, and the first pattern that matches the pack’s folder name wins; 2) if none matches, the class is deduced from the pack’s contents: - **Airport** when the pack contains an `Earth nav data/apt.dat` file, - otherwise **Library** when it contains a `library.txt` file. 3) Packs that match nothing end up in **Other**.

When **Organize scenery_packs.ini** is activated, packs are sorted by the position of their class in the list: the higher a class sits in the table, the earlier its packs appear in scenery_packs.ini.

Open the Scenery classes window via the **Scenery classes...** button in the Scenery panel toolbar.

Rules Table

Column	Description
Priority	Row number (determines rank)
Name	Class name (editable)
RegEx	Regular expression matched against folder names (editable, validated)

Toolbar

- **+** — Add a new regex rule.
- **-** — Delete the selected rule. Built-in rows are italic and cannot be deleted.
- **▲ / ▼** — Move the selected rule up or down.
- **Restore defaults** — Reset all rules to their defaults.

Built-in Classes

These file-based classes are always present and cannot be edited:

- **Airport** — Pack contains `Earth nav data/apt.dat` (airport definition data).
- **Library** — Pack contains `library.txt` (library manifest).
- **Other** — Fallback for packages not matching any other class.

Default Regex Classes

XPman ships with these sensible default classes and name-matching rules:

- **X-Plane Landmark**: matches default X-Plane landmarks
- **Global Airports**: matches the special “Global Airports” folder
- **Overlay scenery**: matches overlays such as `World2XPlane`, ...
- **Mesh scenery**: matches mesh scenery such as `Ortho4XP`, ...

The default classes and their rank are based on best practices for ordering the scenery_pack.ini and are intended to yield a correct order in most of the configurations.

Workflow

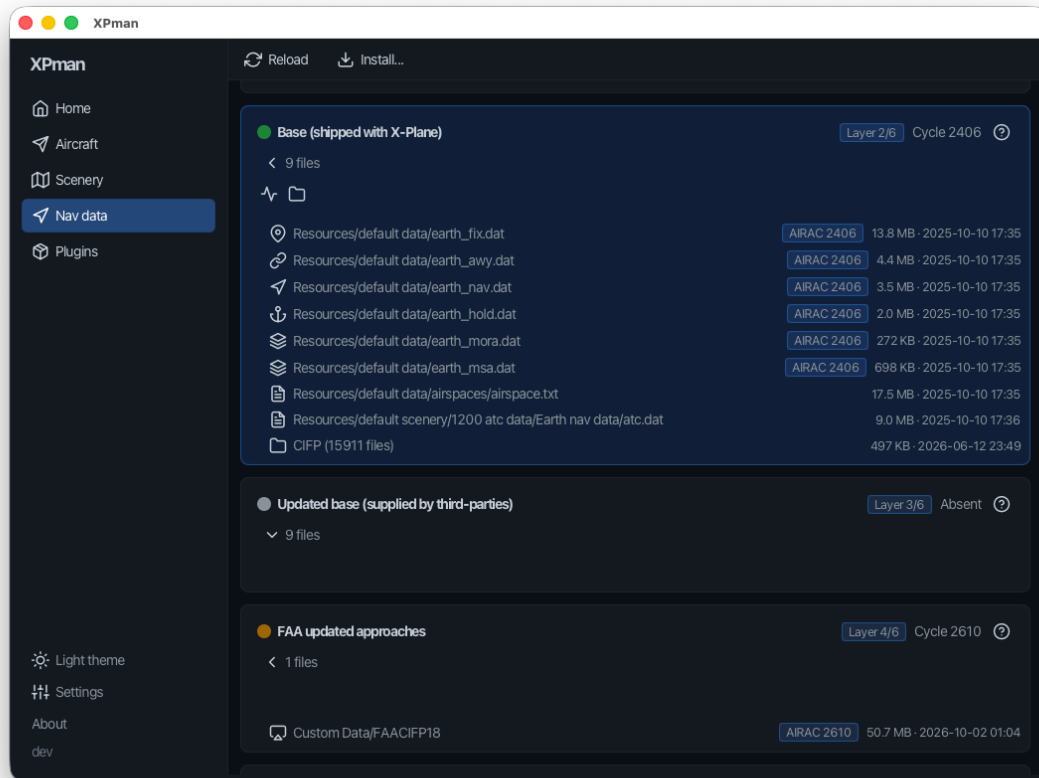
1. Edit the class rules (add, edit, reorder, delete).
2. Click **Apply** — rules are persisted to `~/ .xpman` and the Scenery panel reloads.
3. Optionally go to the Scenery panel and click **Organize scenery_pack.ini** to re-sort by the new class ranks.

4. Review the result and click **Save**.

Buttons

- **Apply** — Persist changes to ~/.xpm and reload the Scenery panel.
- **Close** — Close the window.

Nav Data



The Nav data panel.

Toolbar

- **Reload** — Re-scan navigation data sets.
- **Install...** — Open the universal install wizard for nav data.

Layer Cards

Navigation data is organized as a vertical stack of **layer cards**. Each card shows:

- **Status ball** — Inactive (grey), OK (green), warnings (yellow), or errors (red). Hover for details.
- **Name** — Layer name.
- **Layer i/n badge** — Position in the layer stack (e.g. Layer 3/5).

- **Short state** — e.g. Cycle 2610 (the AIRAC cycle identifier).
- **Help button** (?) — Opens the Nav data info dialog.

Nav Data Info Dialog

Shows the rendered description, folder path, AIRAC cycle, metadata, build information, and a link to the X-Plane nav data documentation.

Override Semantics

- If a layer overrides others, it shows an **“overrides N layers”** badge.
- If a layer is overridden by another, it shows **“ignored by layer i”**.

Files

Each card has an **“N files”** toggle. Expanding it shows per-file rows:

- Icon, file name, absent marker (when the file is missing from disk)
- **AIRAC ...** badge
- Size and modification date

Context Menu

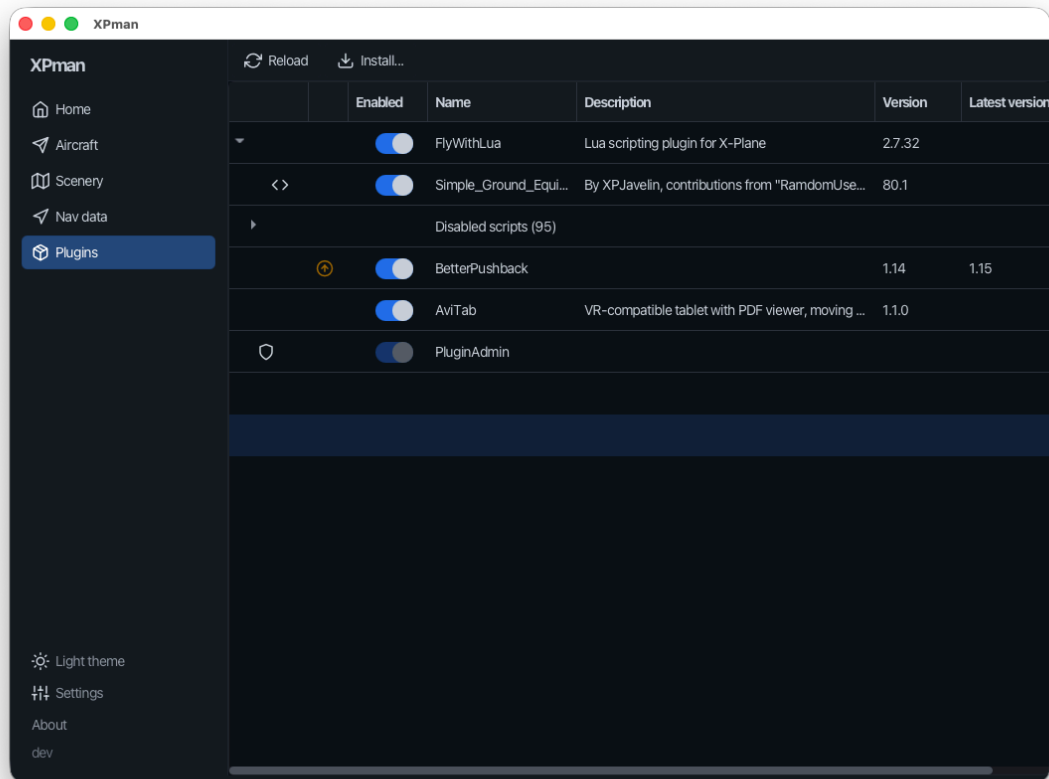
Right-click a layer card for:

- **Reveal** — Show the folder in Finder / Explorer / Files.
- **Inspect** — Opens the Inspection results window.

Empty States

- **“Loading nav data...”** — While scanning.
- **“No nav data to show”** — When no nav data sets are found.

Plugins



The Plugins panel.

Toolbar

- **Reload** — Re-scan plugins.
- **Install...** — Open the universal install wizard for plugins.

Tree Table

Plugins are displayed as a tree. System plugins show a system icon. Columns:

Column	Description
System icon	Shown for built-in/system plugins
Update marker	Shown when an enabled plugin has a Skunkcrafts update available
Enabled	Toggle switch
Name	Plugin name
Description	Short description
Version	Installed version (extracted from native binary)
Latest version	Latest available version

FlyWithLua

The FlyWithLua plugin node expands to show its Lua scripts, plus groups **Disabled scripts (n)** and **Quarantined scripts (n)**.

Plugin Context Menu

Right-click a plugin for:

- **Reveal**
- **Remove macOS quarantine** — Shown only on macOS when the plugin is quarantined.
- **Enable plugin / Disable plugin**
- **Uninstall plugin** — Confirmation dialog with details.
- **Inspect** — Opens Inspection results.
- **Update via Skunkcrafts Updater** — Available only for enabled plugins that support updates.
- **Skunkcrafts: Locked by developer**
- **Links** — Dynamic submenu.
- **Manuals** — Dynamic submenu with PDF manuals.

Script Context Menu (FlyWithLua)

Right-click a FlyWithLua script for:

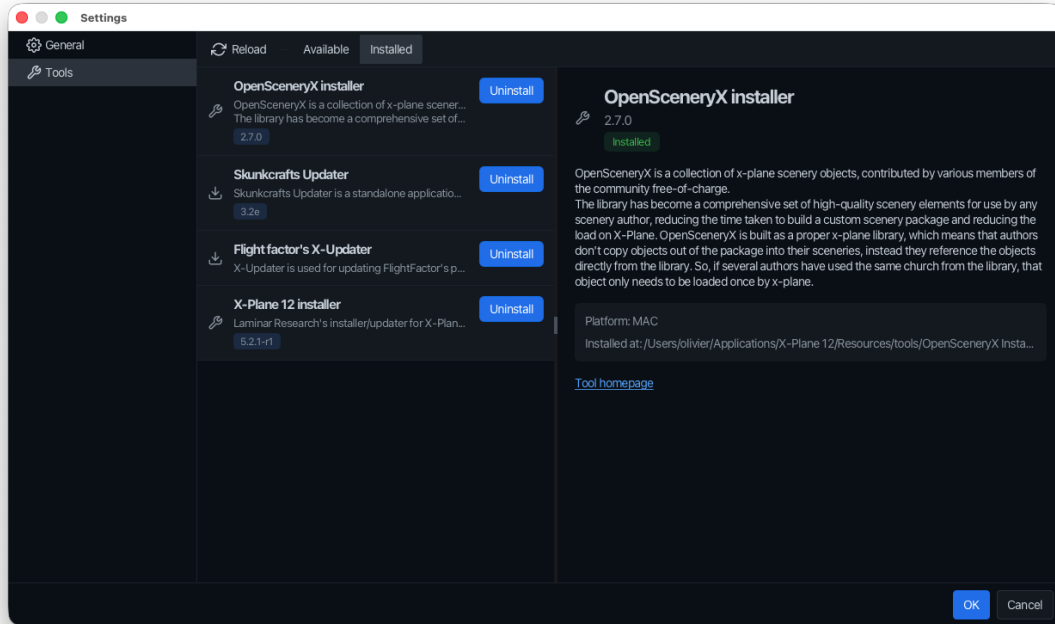
- **Enable script / Disable script**
- **Quarantine script / Unquarantine script**
- **Reveal**
- **Open in text editor**
- **Manuals** — Dynamic submenu.
- **Links** — Dynamic submenu.
- **Uninstall script** — Confirmation dialog.

Empty States

- **“Loading plugins...”** — While scanning.

- “No plugins to show” — When no plugins are found.

Tools



The Tools panel.

Tools are applications that provide additional X-Plane related functionalities, such as: - updating X-Plane (the official X-Plane installer) - installing/updating online traffic models - installing/updating scenery packs - installing/updating add-ons - etc.

Toolbar

- **Reload** — Re-scan available tools.
- **Install...** — Open the universal install wizard for tools.

Tools Manager

Open via **Tools** → **Manage tools...** or **File** → **Settings...** → **Tools**.

The dialog has a segmented filter (**Available** / **Installed**) and two panes:

- **Left** — Tool cards showing name, version, status (Installed / Available), and an **Install** or **Uninstall** action button.
- **Right** — Detail view with icon, name, version, status, description, platform, X-Plane version compatibility, install path, and a **Tool homepage** link.

Install / Uninstall

Installing or uninstalling a tool opens the **Console dialog**:

- Title: “Installing/Uninstalling {tool}”
- Progress indicator and message
- Progress bar
- Output log

Buttons: **Cancel** (during the operation) or **Close** (after completion).

Running Tools

Each installed tool appears as an item in the **Tools** menu. Clicking a tool launches it.

If you try to run a tool that is not installed, XPman asks: “{tool} is not installed. Do you want to install and run it now?”

Installing Add-ons

XPman can install aircraft, scenery, plugins, and tools from .zip or .7z archives via the **Universal installer**. XPman auto-detects the archive content and applies the appropriate installation logic.

Opening the Wizard

- **File** → **Universal installer...**
- Or click **Install...** in any panel’s toolbar.

Page 1 — Source Archive

“Please select source archive (.zip or .7z file).”

- **Source file:** text field + **Browse...** button (file chooser filters for Archives *.zip *.7z).
- **Next** is enabled only when the file exists. If the file does not exist, the validation message “**File does not exist!**” is shown.

Page 2 — Inspection Results

“Please review the messages below and press ‘Next’ to proceed with installation.”

A table with columns:

Column	Description
Severity	Icon indicating severity (info, warning, error)
Message	Description of the finding

XPman auto-detects the archive content (aircraft, scenery, plugin, or tool) and runs inspections. If any **ERROR** is present, **Next** is disabled. Warnings are non-blocking — you can proceed past them.

Page 3 — Installing

“Installing...”

- Current file label and progress bar.
- **Previous** and **Finish** are disabled during installation.
- Errors are shown in an error dialog.
- On success, “**Done!**” is displayed and **Finish** becomes enabled.

Notes

The universal installer handles all supported content types transparently. You don’t need to know whether an archive contains an aircraft, scenery package, plugin, or tool — XPman detects it automatically.

Updating Add-ons

XPman integrates with the **Skunkcrafts Updater** protocol. Plugins, aircraft, and scenery packages that include a `skunkcrafts_updater.cfg` file can be updated directly from their repositories, without requiring installation of the Skunkcraft updater application.

Detecting Updates

- The Home dashboard shows an **Updates Available** section grouped by category.
- Each panel (Aircraft, Scenery, Plugins) shows an update marker on addons with available updates.
- Library tiles show **N updates** badges.
- Disabled plugins and scenery are excluded from update markers, dashboard counts and rows, and update actions. Aircraft are not disableable.

Starting an Update

- Click **Update** in the Home dashboard.
- Or right-click the addon and choose **Update via Skunkcrafts Updater**.

Skunkcrafts Update Wizard

Page 1 — Review

“Review update information.”

Shows:

- **Addon:** name
- **Current version:** installed version
- **Available version:** latest version (or “Could not fetch remote version”)
- **Update status:** “Already up to date” or “N file(s) to update (size)”

Next is disabled when there is nothing to update.

Page 2 — Updating

“Updating...”

- **Preparing update...** label and progress bar.

Locked by Developer

Some addons show **Skunkcrafts: Locked by developer** instead of an update option. This means the developer has disabled remote updates for that addon. Contact the developer for updates.

Settings

Open Settings via **File** → **Settings...** (or Cmd/Ctrl + ,).

The Settings dialog has a category tree on the left and a settings pane on the right. Buttons: **OK** / **Cancel**.

General

- **Confirm quit** — When enabled (default), XPman shows a “**Do you really want to quit?**” dialog on quit.

Tools

Embeds the tools manager (same as **Tools** → **Manage tools...**). Features a **Reload** toolbar, **Available** / **Installed** segmented filter, tool cards on the left, and a detail view on the right.

Persistence

XPman saves your preferences to ~/.xpman (JSON format). The following settings are persisted:

Setting	Description
lastXPlanePath	Last opened X-Plane folder (reopened at startup)
recentPaths	Recent X-Plane folders (File → Open Recent)
theme	"dark" (default) or "light"
confirmQuit	true (default) — show quit confirmation dialog
lastPosition	Main window position and size
settingsPosition	Settings dialog position
settingsCategory	Last selected settings category
sceneryClasses	User-defined scenery organizer rules

Dialog Position

The Settings dialog remembers its position and the last selected category between sessions.

Troubleshooting

Invalid X-Plane Folder

If you select a folder that is not a valid X-Plane installation, XPman shows the error “**Invalid X-Plane folder**”. Ensure you select the top-level X-Plane directory — the one containing the X-Plane executable.

Windows SmartScreen

When running the EXE or MSI installer, Windows SmartScreen may display a warning. Click **More info** then **Run anyway** — XPman is 100% open source and all build code is public and auditable.

See Installation for details.

macOS Gatekeeper

macOS may block the app because it is not signed with an Apple Developer ID. Go to **System Settings > Privacy & Security** and click **Open Anyway** to allow it to run.

See Installation for details.

macOS Quarantine on Plugins

Some plugins downloaded from the internet are quarantined by macOS and will not load. Right-click the plugin in the Plugins panel and choose **Remove macOS quarantine** to allow it to run.

Submitting Issues

If you encounter a bug or unexpected behavior, use **Help → Submit issue...** to open the GitHub issues page. Please include:

- Your X-Plane version
- XPman version (from **Help → About XPman**)
- Steps to reproduce the issue

Logs

XPman logs are written to the console. Use **Help → ? Help** to open the Wiki (this manual). The X-Plane log is accessible via the **Log file** hyperlink on the Home dashboard.

About XPman

Help → About XPman shows:

- Version: X-Plane Manager {version}
- Build: {number} (commit #{hash} on {branch})
- Runtime: {java} {version} {arch}
- VM: {vm} by {vendor}
- CPU: {type} ({n} cores)

- Link to the GitHub repository
- License: GPLv3